

CLAT Express - February 2026: Practice Quizzes

MCQ: +1 for a correct answer, -0.25 for a wrong answer. TITA (type-in-the-answer): +1, no negative marking.

Multiple-choice passages

Supreme Court Verdict Practice

The Supreme Court of the United States has struck down a set of tariffs that President Donald Trump imposed under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act, commonly called IEEPA. The Court's decision was a 6-3 verdict. Chief Justice John Roberts clarified that IEEPA does not allow a President to take unilateral tariff actions without approval from Congress. In his reasoning, the word 'regulate' in IEEPA does not mean 'tax'. The Court observed that IEEPA was designed for emergency economic restrictions, not for general tariff policy. As a result, the Liberation Day tariffs, introduced through an executive order dated 2 April 2025, were invalidated. Before this order, no American President had used IEEPA as a means to impose trade tariffs. The judgment has also raised questions about whether tariffs already collected can be refunded. It has further raised questions about the direction of future American trade policy. Indian exporters are among those affected, since the Liberation Day tariffs had applied to many of their goods. Any broad tariff measure now needs authorisation from Congress, which places a limit on the use of emergency powers for trade protectionism.

Q1.

Which of the following Justices dissented from the majority in the Supreme Court's ruling against the IEEPA tariffs?

- (A) Brett Kavanaugh
- (B) Amy Coney Barrett
- (C) Neil Gorsuch
- (D) Sonia Sotomayor

Q2.

Consider the following statements about IEEPA:

- I. It was enacted in 1977 to replace the Trading with the Enemy Act of 1917.
- II. It was primarily designed as a general tariff law.
- III. The President must formally declare a National Emergency before invoking it.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q3.

How many of the following statements about the Liberation Day tariffs are correct?

- I. They were introduced through an executive order dated 2 April 2025.
- II. They were upheld by the Supreme Court in its IEEPA ruling.
- III. They were declared under Section 232 of the Trade Expansion Act 1962.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only three
- (C) None of the above
- (D) Only one

Q4.

Under which section did the President impose a 10% temporary tariff on goods from all countries?

- (A) Section 122 of the Trade Act 1974
- (B) Section 338 of the Tariff Act 1930
- (C) Section 232 of the Trade Expansion Act 1962
- (D) Section 301 of the Trade Act 1974

Q5.

Which goods imported from India will continue to face a 25% tariff under Section 232 despite the Supreme Court ruling?

- (A) Select automotive components
- (B) Agricultural exports such as cotton and nuts
- (C) Pharmaceutical exports
- (D) Textiles and apparel

Q6.

Approximately what share of India's exports to the US benefits from the rollback of the Liberation Day tariffs?

- (A) 18%
- (B) 25%
- (C) 50%
- (D) 55%

New START Expiry Check

A major nuclear arms control agreement has now reached its end. The New Strategic Arms Reduction Treaty, known as New START, expired in early February 2026, leaving no legally binding limits on the strategic nuclear arsenals of the United States and Russia. This ends the last legally binding nuclear arms control pact between the United States and Russia. Earlier arms control efforts had rested on a sequence of agreements, from the ABM Treaty to the later START pacts. Its expiry comes amid worsening geopolitical tensions, and the treaty had originally been signed in 2010 and extended by the Biden administration. The treaty was approaching its final expiry as relations between the two countries deteriorated, particularly because of the Ukraine conflict and growing strategic mistrust. Negotiations have stalled. Russia has suspended the sharing of information about its nuclear forces, citing concerns about possible aggression, while the United States accuses Russia of non-compliance and unreliability. Such a breakdown weakens the transparency and verification that once made nuclear arsenals predictable. Without verified data, both sides may assume worst-case scenarios, and heightened mistrust raises the chance of miscalculation. Historical experience suggests that unchecked arms competition can spiral into conflict. The end of the treaty therefore threatens global strategic stability by amplifying uncertainty and increasing the risk of unintended confrontation.

Q1.

In which city is the headquarters of the International Atomic Energy Agency located?

- (A) Vienna, Austria
- (B) Geneva, Switzerland
- (C) Paris, France
- (D) Brussels, Belgium

Q2.

Which group was awarded the 2024 Nobel Peace Prize for efforts toward a nuclear-free world?

- (A) Rafael Grossi
- (B) The Red Cross
- (C) Homi J. Bhabha
- (D) Nihon Hidankyo

Q3.

How many of the following statements about India's nuclear history are correct?

- I. India conducted Pokhran-I, its first nuclear test, on 18 May 1974.
- II. India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime in 2016.
- III. India's first nuclear test took place in 1998 during Pokhran-II.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q4.

On which date did the New START Treaty officially expire?

- (A) 5 February 2026
- (B) 5 February 2021
- (C) 11 May 1998
- (D) 5 February 2011

Q5.

Consider the following statements about arms control:

- I. The Anti-Ballistic Missile Treaty restricted the deployment of missile defence systems.
- II. The United States ratified SALT II in 1979.
- III. The Wassenaar Arrangement has 42 members.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

What is the ceiling on operationally deployed strategic nuclear warheads for each country under New START?

- (A) 2200
- (B) 6000
- (C) 3500
- (D) 1550

Q7.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Australia Group	A. Bans deployment of weapons of mass destruction in outer space
II. Wassenaar Arrangement	B. Informal export control forum formed after chemical weapons use in Iran-Iraq War
III. Missile Technology Control Regime	C. Voluntary export control regime for conventional arms and dual-use goods
IV. Outer Space Treaty	D. Informal understanding to prevent spread of missiles and UAVs capable of delivering WMD

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Tarique Rahman's Rise: Practice MCQs

Bangladesh entered a new political phase in February 2026. The Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP), led by Tarique Rahman, won the 13th General Election and ended the Awami League's long dominance in the country. The result came after roughly eighteen months of upheaval and marked a major political shift. The BNP has a long history in Bangladesh's politics, and its win gave it an absolute majority in the legislature.

Tarique Rahman succeeded the government of Sheikh Hasina, which had been overthrown. He had come back to Bangladesh before taking up the highest office, and he is now the country's Prime Minister. He took the oath of office at Parliament South Plaza in Dhaka, and Om Birla attended the swearing-in ceremony.

His rise marks the emergence of a new top leader for the BNP. The party's leadership now faces the task of governing a country that has been through a period of political instability. The change follows a student-led revolution and Hasina's flight to India, which left the country in a period of political uncertainty. The election result and the swearing-in have drawn attention both inside Bangladesh and across the region. The booklet presents this as a major turning point in the country's current affairs.

Q1.

After how many years did Tarique Rahman return to Bangladesh?

- (A) 12 years
- (B) 15 years
- (C) 17 years
- (D) 20 years

Q2.

Who founded the Bangladesh Nationalist Party?

- (A) General Ziaur Rahman
- (B) Khaleda Zia
- (C) Sheikh Mujibur Rahman
- (D) Tarique Rahman

Q3.

Read the following statements.

Assertion (A): Bangladesh's national legislature is unicameral.

Reason (R): 300 members are elected directly through the first-past-the-post system.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Seats in the new Upper House (Senate)	A. 65.3%
II. Seats in the Lower House	B. 10 years
III. Lifetime term cap for a Prime Minister	C. 100
IV. Yes votes in the referendum	D. 400

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Sheikh Mujibur Rahman was assassinated on 15 August 1975.
- II. Ziaur Rahman was assassinated in 1975.
- III. Sheikh Hasina was sworn in as Prime Minister for the first time in 1996.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Teesta River:

- I. It originates from the glacial lake Khangchung Chho in Sikkim.
- II. Its total length is 414 km.
- III. It empties directly into the Brahmaputra.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

India accused the 2001-2006 BNP-led government of sheltering which North-East insurgent group, among others?

- (A) Hizbul Mujahideen
- (B) LTTE
- (C) Mukti Bahini
- (D) United Liberation Front of Assam

Q8.

In which year was Khaleda Zia sworn in as Bangladesh's first female Prime Minister?

- (A) 1981
- (B) 1986
- (C) 1991
- (D) 1996

New Government Check

Manipur has moved back to an elected government after nearly one year of direct central control. The state's administration was run by the Centre because the state government could not control a crisis in which violence broke out between Kuki-Zomi tribal groups and the Meitei community. Reports described it as the first clash of this kind in three decades in the state. The President revoked the arrangement, clearing the way for an elected government to take office. The new chief minister belongs to the Bharatiya Janata Party. Two deputy chief ministers were also sworn in, one from the Kuki-Zo community and one from the Naga community. Their presence reflects the state's mix of communities, which has long shaped its politics. The oath-taking marked the start of a new government after a long period without one. The roots of the conflict go back much further. The Meitei community lives mainly in the valley, which covers a small share of the state's land, while the hill areas cover most of it. Land purchase rules differ between the two regions. Disputes over census figures, the delimitation process and demands for tribal status have added to the tension between communities. The Meitei community has also raised concerns about inaccurate census figures from 2020. Critics have raised allegations of human rights abuses in affected regions, where the armed forces have extensive powers. Demands for autonomy from Nagas and Kukis have also been part of the state's politics for years.

Q1.

Which state has experienced President's Rule the most number of times?

- (A) Jammu & Kashmir
- (B) Punjab
- (C) Uttar Pradesh
- (D) Manipur

Q2.

Which constituency is represented by Deputy Chief Minister Losii Dikho?

- (A) Senapati
- (B) Imphal
- (C) Mao
- (D) Kangpokpi

Q3.

How many of the following statements about President's Rule are correct?

- I. A resolution approving the proclamation needs a simple majority in either House.
 - II. The President needs Parliament's approval to revoke a proclamation.
 - III. President's Rule can be extended up to a maximum period of 3 years with Parliament's approval.
 - IV. Jammu and Kashmir had the shortest single period under President's Rule.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None

Q4.

Consider the following statements about President's Rule in India:

- I. Under Article 356, President's Rule can be imposed when the constitutional machinery of a state fails.
- II. A proclamation must be approved by both Houses of Parliament within 2 months of its issue.
- III. The President needs Parliament's approval to revoke a proclamation of President's Rule.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Who was sworn in as the 13th Chief Minister of Manipur?

- (A) Yumnam Khemchand Singh
- (B) N. Biren Singh
- (C) Okram Ibobi Singh
- (D) Mairembam Koireng Singh

Q6.

Assertion (A): Manipur became a Union Territory before it attained full statehood.

Reason (R): The Meitei community currently holds Scheduled Tribe status in Manipur.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q7.

Under which Article can the President issue a proclamation if a state fails to comply with directions from the Centre?

- (A) Article 356
- (B) Article 352
- (C) Article 365
- (D) Article 355

Q8.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. 1891	A. Maharaja Budhachandra signed the Treaty of Accession
II. 1947	B. Manipur became a Union Territory
III. 1956	C. Demand for ST status for the Meitei community persisted
IV. 2012	D. Manipur became a Princely State under British rule

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Manufacturing and Infrastructure Check

Union Budget 2026-27 places manufacturing and infrastructure at the centre of the government's growth plan. The budget describes a push to scale up production in several strategic sectors and to revive older industrial sectors so that they become more productive and competitive. Among the sectors named are biopharmaceuticals, electronics, semiconductors and critical minerals. A biopharma scheme called SHAKTI is meant to strengthen domestic production of advanced medicines, while the semiconductor programme is expected to move from assembly toward higher-value manufacturing and home-grown intellectual property. A separate scheme is planned to build a domestic container manufacturing base. The plan also addresses heavy industries whose emissions are hard to cut, and it funds technologies that capture carbon for those sectors. On infrastructure, the budget proposes new freight and rail links, along with city-to-city connectors meant to speed up movement between major urban centres. Finally, the budget plans to map cities according to their economic strengths so that each region can pursue its own growth drivers. The budget presents these measures as part of a broader blueprint for economic growth that puts young people at its centre.

Q1.

What does the acronym SHAKTI stand for in the Biopharma SHAKTI scheme?

- (A) Scheme for Healthcare and Knowledge Transfer in Agro Industries
- (B) Strategy for Health Assistance through Key Technical Investment
- (C) Strategy for Healthcare Advancement through Knowledge, Technology and Innovation
- (D) Strategic Hub for Automated Knowledge and Trade Infrastructure

Q2.

Foreign companies providing cloud services to global customers from Indian data centres receive a tax holiday until which year?

- (A) 2030
- (B) 2035
- (C) 2050
- (D) 2047

Q3.

Under the City Economic Regions initiative, what is the allocation per region over 5 years?

- (A) 1,000 crore
- (B) 5,000 crore
- (C) 10,000 crore
- (D) 20,000 crore

Q4.

Assertion (A): The container scheme in the budget is meant to increase dependence on Chinese imports.

Reason (R): A dedicated container manufacturing ecosystem is meant to reduce dependence on Chinese imports.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Infrastructure Risk Guarantee Fund	A. Multi-lingual AI-based agriculture platform
II. Carbon Capture, Utilisation and Storage (CCUS)	B. Partial credit guarantees to lenders
III. Bharat-VISTAAR	C. Scaling MSMEs into Champion enterprises
IV. SME Growth Fund	D. Decarbonising steel and cement

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Rare Earth Corridor will be developed across four states, including Kerala.
- II. A proposed Dedicated Freight Corridor connects Dankuni with Surat.
- III. Five High-Speed Rail Corridors will be developed as Growth Connectors.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the SME Growth Fund:

- I. It is a dedicated fund of 10,000 crore.
- II. It aims to scale high-potential MSMEs into Champion enterprises.
- III. It is meant only for large corporations, not MSMEs.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q8.

What is the target value of India's Bio-Economy by 2030?

- (A) USD 300 Billion
- (B) USD 150 Billion
- (C) USD 500 Billion
- (D) USD 50 Billion

Devolution and fiscal recall

The 16th Finance Commission's recommendations for 2026-31 shape how tax revenue is shared between the Centre and the States. The first stage of sharing is vertical devolution, which fixes the overall share of the Centre's divisible tax pool that States receive. The Commission has kept this share at 41 per cent, the same level set by the previous Commission. The divisible pool covers the Centre's gross tax revenues but leaves out cesses, surcharges and the cost of collection. States have raised concerns that these levies are kept by the Union and not shared, which reduces the untied fiscal space available to them. The second stage is horizontal devolution, which decides how the 41 per cent share is apportioned among individual States. The revised criteria add contribution to GDP as a new parameter, while income distance and geographical area are given less weight. Demographic performance also receives less weight, which has raised fears of an 'Ageing Before Prosperity' problem in some Southern States. The package also seeks fiscal discipline, with the Commission proposing deficit limits for both the Centre and the States by 2030-31. Together, these measures aim to balance fiscal federalism, equity and economic performance.

Q1.

What weight does the revised horizontal devolution formula give to Population (2011)?

- (A) 17.5%
- (B) 15%
- (C) 12.5%
- (D) 10%

Q2.

What fiscal deficit target has the Commission recommended for the Centre by 2030-31?

- (A) 3% of GDP
- (B) 4% of GDP
- (C) 3.5% of GDP
- (D) 4.5% of GDP

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Statutory grants	A. Article 282
II. Discretionary grants	B. Article 281
III. Constitution of the Finance Commission	C. Article 275
IV. Report laid before Parliament	D. Article 280

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the 16th Finance Commission's recommendations:

- I. The Centre's fiscal deficit is to be reduced to 3.5% of GDP by 2030-31.
- II. States are recommended to end off-budget borrowings to enhance fiscal transparency.
- III. The cost-sharing ratio for disaster management in other States is 90:10.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Dr. Arvind Panagariya chairs the 16th Finance Commission.
- II. Cesses and surcharges form part of the divisible pool.
- III. The 16th Finance Commission was set up under Article 281.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) All three
- (B) None
- (C) Only one
- (D) Only two

Q6.

Which levy is described as a 'tax on tax' imposed by the Central Government for specific purposes such as education and health?

- (A) Surcharge
- (B) Statutory grant
- (C) SASCI loan
- (D) Cess

CPI revision: reasons and method

A price index is useful only when it reflects what people actually buy. An economy changes over time, and so do the habits of households. Consumer spending has become more varied, cities have grown, and many purchases now happen digitally. A consumer price index that keeps an old set of items and weights can therefore give a distorted picture of living costs. The statistical agency that compiles the index must periodically revisit the base year, the basket of goods and services, and the weights given to each item. The new base year is chosen with care, using evidence from a recent household expenditure survey and from an advisory committee of experts. Pay revisions, pension adjustments and policy decisions can all depend on the index. If the index does not match real price changes, these payments and decisions may be wrong.

Q1.

Which ministry revised the CPI base year to 2024?

- (A) Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation
- (B) Ministry of Finance
- (C) Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- (D) Ministry of Consumer Affairs

Q2.

Which CPI base year was replaced by the 2024 base year?

- (A) 2011
- (B) 2010
- (C) 2015
- (D) 2012

Q3.

Who was appointed Chairman of the 26-member Advisory Committee on National Accounts Statistics?

- (A) Shaktikanta Das
- (B) Biswanath Goldar
- (C) Raghuram Rajan
- (D) Urjit Patel

Q4.

Assertion (A): The 2024 CPI base year was identified using data from the 2011 Census of India.

Reason (R): The 2023-24 Household Consumer Expenditure Survey was used to identify the new CPI base year.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Revised CPI base year	A. Biswanath Goldar
II. Replaced CPI base year	B. Laspeyres Index
III. Chairman of the advisory committee	C. 2012
IV. Formula used for the revised CPI	D. 2024

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The CPI 2024 basket contains 358 items, of which 50 are services.
- II. Online markets were covered under the CPI 2012 basket.
- III. The CPI 2024 groups its items in line with COICOP 2018.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I, II and III
- (C) I and III only
- (D) II and III only

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Overall inflation in January 2026 was 2.75% on a year-on-year basis (provisional).
- II. Rural inflation in January 2026 was higher than urban inflation.
- III. FY 2022-23 is the revised base year for the new GDP series.
- IV. Tape recorders were added to the CPI 2024 basket.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q8.

Which of the following items was newly added in the CPI 2024 basket?

- (A) OTT Subscriptions
- (B) Cassettes
- (C) Radios
- (D) Second Hand Clothing

Declaration and Commitments

India hosted the India AI Impact Summit 2026 at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi, and the event marked an important step for the Global South in artificial intelligence governance. The summit's central outcome is the New Delhi Declaration on AI, which focuses on AI that is inclusive, ethical and oriented to development. Rather than limiting the discussion to risks alone, the declaration asks how AI can deliver practical benefits to ordinary people. Its framework is organised into seven pillars, and each pillar is backed by voluntary global initiatives. Some pillars concern sharing solutions, some concern shared tools and standards, and others concern workforce preparation and energy-efficient systems. Alongside it, a separate voluntary framework for frontier AI developers was launched, with a focus on equitable access and real-world understanding of how AI is used.

Q1.

Which New Delhi Declaration pillar is a platform for sharing successful AI solutions and enabling replication of best practices globally?

- (A) Trusted AI Commons
- (B) AI for Social Empowerment Platform
- (C) Charter for Democratic Diffusion of AI
- (D) Global AI Impact Commons

Q2.

Which of the three Sutras stands for Sustainable Societal Impact?

- (A) People
- (B) Planet
- (C) Profit
- (D) Progress

Q3.

How many countries endorsed the New Delhi Declaration on AI, excluding international organisations?

- (A) 87
- (B) 78
- (C) 27
- (D) 102

Q4.

Assertion (A): Accountable Governance is one of the principles of the M.A.N.A.V. framework.

Reason (R): The 'N' in M.A.N.A.V. stands for Non-biased Algorithms.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. VoicERA	A. Privacy-preserving benchmarking platform for health AI
II. BODH	B. Multilingual foundational AI model by BharatGen
III. Vachana	C. National execution layer for multilingual voice and language AI
IV. Param2 17B	D. Text-to-speech model supporting 12 Indian languages

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

I. BODH is positioned under the Digital India BHASHINI Division.

II. The GPAI secretariat is based in Paris, at the OECD.

III. The IndiaAI Mission's initial GPU target of 10,000 was exceeded, reaching 38,000 GPUs.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) II and III only

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the M.A.N.A.V. framework are correct?

- a. The 'M' stands for Moral and Ethical Systems.
 - b. The framework was unveiled at the Paris AI Action Summit 2025.
 - c. The 'V' stands for Valid and Legitimate Systems.
- (A) All three
(B) Only one
(C) Only two
(D) None

Q8.

Bharat GenAI's sovereign foundational models are tailored to how many Indian languages?

- (A) 22
(B) 12
(C) 18
(D) 24

CPI 2025 Global Picture and Bodies

The Corruption Perceptions Index 2025 was released to assess public sector corruption across 182 countries. Each country is placed on a scale from 0 to 100, where 0 stands for highly corrupt and 100 stands for very clean. The global average score fell to 42, which is the lowest level in over a decade and points to worsening corruption trends worldwide. Around 122 of the 182 countries scored below 50, which shows that serious corruption challenges exist in most nations. Denmark placed first with a score of 89, while only five countries scored above 80, compared with twelve a decade ago. This decline suggests an erosion of governance standards even among countries that once performed strongly. India ranked 91st with a score of 39 out of 100, a figure that sits below the global average. Countries such as Somalia and South Sudan, each scoring 9, ranked among the most corrupt, along with Venezuela. The index began in 1995 and is treated as a leading global indicator of public sector corruption. Countries are compared on the same scale, so their positions can be read side by side. It also highlights how corruption hinders global efforts to combat climate change, and it recommends measures to strengthen institutional integrity.

Q1.

Where is the headquarters of Transparency International, the organisation that releases the Corruption Perceptions Index?

- (A) Geneva, Switzerland
(B) Paris, France
(C) London, United Kingdom
(D) Berlin, Germany

Q2.

Assertion (A): India's rank in the Corruption Perceptions Index 2025 improved compared with 2024.

Reason (R): India's CPI 2025 score of 39 remains below the global average of 42.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
(B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
(C) A is true but R is false
(D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Which Act provides penalties for corruption by public servants and for abetment of an act of corruption?

- (A) Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988
- (B) Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002
- (C) Right to Information Act, 2005
- (D) Whistleblower Protection Act, 2014

Q4.

In which year was Transparency International founded?

- (A) 1989
- (B) 1993
- (C) 1995
- (D) 2003

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Central Bureau of Investigation	A. Established in 1956 as Enforcement Unit
II. Directorate of Enforcement	B. Statutory status under CVC Act 2003
III. Central Vigilance Commission	C. Art 148
IV. Comptroller and Auditor General	D. Formed in 1963

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements about INTERPOL:

- I. INTERPOL was established in 1923.
- II. Its General Secretariat coordinates policing and administrative tasks.
- III. Its Secretary-General is appointed by the Executive Committee.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the Corruption Perceptions Index 2025 are correct?

- I. CPI 2025 assessed 182 countries.
- II. Denmark ranked first with a score of 89.
- III. India ranked 96th in CPI 2025.
- IV. The global average CPI score was 42.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All four

Q8.

What is the tenure and age limit of the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) of India?

- (A) 6 years or up to the age of 65 years
- (B) 4 years or up to the age of 70 years
- (C) 5 years or up to the age of 62 years
- (D) Indefinite tenure at the pleasure of the President

Project and Clearance Practice

The Great Nicobar Mega Infrastructure Project has returned to the spotlight after the National Green Tribunal upheld its Environmental Clearance. The Tribunal found that the project complied with the coastal norms that apply to the island. Great Nicobar is the largest island of the Nicobar group and sits at the southern end of India, where a dense green cover of trees meets long coastlines. Planners see the project as a major step in building trade and strategic capacity near the Malacca Strait. Critics, however, have questioned whether the damage to the island's fragile ecology can be offset. The island is also home to tribal communities. This debate highlights a familiar challenge in India: how to balance national economic and strategic goals with the protection of ecologically sensitive regions and their people. Understanding the project therefore requires knowing about the island's location, its ecology, the people who live there and the legal bodies that review such proposals.

Q1.

Which two national parks are associated with Great Nicobar Island?

- (A) Indira Point and Shompen
- (B) Campbell Bay and Galathea Bay
- (C) Nicobar and Andaman
- (D) Malacca and Singapore

Q2.

Consider the following components of the Great Nicobar Mega Infrastructure Project:

- I. An International Container Transshipment Terminal
- II. A 450 MVA gas and solar-based power plant
- III. A nuclear power plant
- IV. A dual-use civil-military airport

How many of the above components are included in the project?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only four
- (D) Only three

Q3.

Who is appointed as the Chairperson of the National Green Tribunal?

- (A) A serving Union Cabinet Minister
- (B) A retired Supreme Court judge or High Court Chief Justice
- (C) The Chief Justice of India
- (D) A Secretary of the Ministry of Environment

Q4.

In which year was the Great Nicobar Mega Infrastructure Project launched?

- (A) 2019
- (B) 2020
- (C) 2021
- (D) 2022

Q5.

Which ecosystem is mostly found on Great Nicobar Island and is expected to be affected by the project?

- (A) Tropical rainforest
- (B) Mangrove forest
- (C) Deciduous forest
- (D) Alpine forest

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Shompen	A. Southernmost point of India
II. Indira Point	B. National Park
III. Barren Island	C. Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group
IV. Campbell Bay	D. Active volcano

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Wetlands and the Ramsar Framework

Wetlands are places where land is covered by water, whether the water is salt, fresh or somewhere in between, and whether the cover is seasonal or permanent. The category is broad, and every form of water cover described here is treated as part of one wetland definition. It includes lakes, rivers, underground aquifers, swamps, wet grasslands and peatlands, along with deltas, tidal flats, mangroves, coral reefs and other coastal areas. For classification, wetlands are divided into three segments. The international framework that protects these ecosystems is a treaty that deals with one specific type of habitat. Its formal name is the Convention on Wetlands of International Importance, and it is the only international treaty that addresses a specific ecosystem. Its members meet at a Conference of Parties. Wetland sites that fall under it are known as Ramsar Sites, and India is one of the signatories. A separate register tracks wetland sites where ecological character has changed, is changing, or is likely to change. Such changes can result from technological developments, pollution or other human interference. A site entered on this register shows that its ecological character is under pressure. World Wetlands Day is observed each year, and each year carries its own theme that draws attention to wetland care.

Q1.

Which country has the largest area under protection of the Ramsar Convention?

- (A) United Kingdom
- (B) Mexico
- (C) Bolivia
- (D) China

Q2.

How often does the Conference of Parties (COP) to the Ramsar Convention meet?

- (A) Every 3 years
- (B) Every 2 years
- (C) Every 5 years
- (D) Every year

Q3.

In which year was the Montreux Record launched?

- (A) 1971
- (B) 1990
- (C) 1982
- (D) 2015

Q4.

Read the two statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): Human-made wetlands are one of the three segments used to classify wetlands.

Reason (R): Wetlands are defined only as natural water bodies such as lakes and rivers.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Patna Bird Sanctuary	A. 6 years
II. Chhari-Dhand Wetland Reserve	B. Etah District, Uttar Pradesh
III. Wetland City Accreditation validity	C. Victoria Falls, Zimbabwe
IV. Ramsar COP15 venue	D. Chir Batti night lights

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements about wetlands and the Ramsar Convention:

- I. Coral reefs and mangroves are included among wetlands.
- II. The Montreux Record lists wetland sites where ecological character has changed due to human interference.
- III. Chilka Lake is currently listed in the Montreux Record.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the Ramsar Convention are correct?

- I. It was signed in 1971 in Ramsar, Iran.
- II. It came into force in 1980.
- III. India became a signatory on 1 February 1982.
- IV. It has 172 member States.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Q8.

Which Indian wetland was placed in the Montreux Record and later removed from it?

- (A) Chilka Lake
- (B) Keoladeo National Park
- (C) Loktak Lake
- (D) Patna Bird Sanctuary

Parliament, Governor and Speaker

Each year, Parliament opens its work with a formal address. At the start of the first session each year, the President addresses both Houses of Parliament assembled together. The address informs Parliament of the reasons for its summons and sets out the policies and legislative agenda of the elected government. After the address, a motion of thanks is moved in the Lok Sabha and discussed. Members may move amendments that express regret or disapproval, for example by pointing to important issues that the address has omitted. Passing the motion indicates the House's confidence in the government. State legislatures follow a similar pattern, with the Governor delivering an address to the Legislative Assembly. The Governor acts as a constitutional head, so the address reflects the policies of the elected government and not the personal opinion of the Governor. The Speaker of the Lok Sabha holds a different kind of office. The House can remove the Speaker through a resolution, but the process requires advance notice and a formal listing in the business of the House. While the removal is under consideration, the Speaker faces specific limits on the role they can play in the House. These rules show how the Constitution balances the roles of the elected government, the presiding officers and the constitutional heads.

Q1.

Consider the following statements about the motion of thanks:

- I. The Prime Minister conventionally replies at the end of the discussion on the motion.
- II. Passage of an amendment to the motion amounts to a direct dissolution of the government.
- III. Defeat of the motion automatically requires the government to resign.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 87(1)	A. Governor acts on aid and advice of the Council of Ministers
II. Article 176	B. Removal of Speaker or Deputy Speaker by resolution
III. Article 163	C. Governor's address to the State Legislature
IV. Article 94	D. President's address to both Houses of Parliament

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A

Q3.

During the discussion on their own removal, which power can the Lok Sabha Speaker still exercise?

- (A) Presiding over the House
- (B) Speaking and voting in the first instance
- (C) Casting vote in case of a tie
- (D) Moving the removal resolution

Q4.

Which address is delivered at the commencement of the first session after each general election to the Lok Sabha, as well as at the first session of each year?

- (A) The Governor's address to the State Legislature
- (B) The Prime Minister's reply to the motion of thanks
- (C) The President's address to both Houses of Parliament
- (D) The Speaker's address to the Lok Sabha

Q5.

The booklet describes three past instances in which a motion to remove a Lok Sabha Speaker was moved (1954, 1966 and 1987). How many of these Speakers were actually removed?

- (A) One
- (B) Two
- (C) All three
- (D) None

Q6.

What is the minimum notice period before a resolution to remove the Lok Sabha Speaker can be moved?

- (A) 7 days
- (B) 10 days
- (C) 21 days
- (D) 14 days

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Speaker can be removed by a resolution passed by a majority of all the then members of the House.
- II. The Speaker may exercise a casting vote in case of a tie during discussion on own removal.
- III. The Speaker cannot preside over the House during discussion on own removal.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Defence and missiles: MCQ practice

February 2026 brought several developments in India's defence sector. The Agni-III missile was successfully tested, a step that strengthens the country's strategic deterrence and its capacity for long-range strikes. The missile belongs to the ballistic class. Alongside missiles, engine development also drew attention. Progress on the Kaveri Engine Programme was reviewed at a research establishment, with the aim of strengthening indigenous military aviation capability. The review focused on progress made so far. The programme is part of India's Aatmanirbhar Bharat push in defence technology and seeks an indigenous jet engine for fighter aircraft. On the global stage, the World Defence Show 2026 was held as a major international exhibition. The event showcased innovations across the defence sector. Its exhibits covered new technologies. Together, these developments show how missile testing, engine research and international showcases fit into

the wider defence agenda. Each one links a technology to a national goal, and this link is worth remembering.

Q1.

How often is the World Defence Show held, according to the booklet?

- (A) Biennial
- (B) Annual
- (C) Every five years
- (D) Once in a decade

Q2.

Assertion (A): The Agni-III missile can carry nuclear warheads.

Reason (R): Agni-III was developed by the Gas Turbine Research Establishment.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is false but R is true
- (D) A is true but R is false

Q3.

The Kaveri Engine Programme is an indigenous jet engine effort meant for which aircraft?

- (A) Commercial airliners
- (B) LCA Tejas
- (C) Cargo drones
- (D) Rocket boosters

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Venue where Kaveri Engine Programme progress was reviewed	A. Defence Research and Development Organisation
II. Developer of the Agni-III missile	B. General Authority for Military Industries
III. Organiser of the World Defence Show	C. Riyadh
IV. Host city of the World Defence Show 2026	D. Gas Turbine Research Establishment

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B

Q5.

Which of these is NOT among the five defence domains showcased at the World Defence Show 2026?

- (A) Air
- (B) Sea
- (C) Cyber
- (D) Space

Q6.

The booklet describes the range of the Agni-III missile as which of the following?

- (A) Under 1000 km
- (B) Up to 2000 km
- (C) Beyond 3000 km
- (D) Under 500 km

Q7.

- I. The Agni-III missile is powered by a two-stage solid-fuel system.
- II. The Kaveri Engine Programme seeks an indigenous jet engine for fighter aircraft.
- III. The World Defence Show is held every year.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q8.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Agni-III missile can carry only conventional warheads.
- II. The Agni-III missile was tested from Odisha.
- III. A jet engine converts chemical energy of fuel into mechanical energy and thrust.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Type-in-the-answer passages

Alternative Tariff Laws Recall

After the Supreme Court limited the use of emergency economic powers for tariffs, the government had to look to other statutes. The Trade Act of 1974 contains a provision that lets the President impose temporary tariffs. Its purpose is to protect domestic industries and to address trade imbalances or unfair trade practices. The President has used this power to impose a temporary tariff on goods from all countries. A separate provision of the same Act allows action against foreign regulations that unfairly burden American trade. Another route is the Tariff Act of 1930, which permits import tariffs against countries with discriminatory trade practices. The Trade Expansion Act of 1962 allows import restrictions on goods that threaten national security, and this power has been applied to steel and aluminium. Taken together, these laws show that tariff policy can be pursued through specific statutes rather than through emergency powers. Each of these laws addresses a different kind of trade problem, such as a trade imbalance, a threat to national security, unfair foreign regulations or discriminatory trade practices. The government's options therefore depended on matching the legal tool to the specific concern. After the ruling, officials had to choose among these statutes while keeping within the conditions that each one sets out in its own text.

Q1.

For how many days at most can a temporary tariff under the Trade Act 1974's temporary-tariff provision be imposed? (in days)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the maximum temporary tariff rate, in per cent, that Section 122 permits?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What rate, in per cent, did the President impose on goods from all countries under Section 122?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the maximum import tariff rate, in per cent, that the Tariff Act 1930 permits against countries with discriminatory trade practices? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which section of the Tariff Act 1930 allows import tariffs against countries with discriminatory trade practices? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which section of the Trade Expansion Act 1962 authorises import restrictions on goods threatening national security? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which section number of the Trade Act 1974 was used to impose the 10% temporary tariff on goods from all countries? (give the number)

Answer: _____

India's Nuclear Milestones

India's nuclear journey began with an institutional foundation laid under the guidance of a physicist widely regarded as the father of the country's nuclear programme. Within a few years of that foundation, a reactor became operational, marking the first nuclear reactor in Asia. Later, a power plant became the country's first commercial nuclear power station, built with support from the United States and the IAEA. Decades later, India's testing record drew global attention. In May 1998, India carried out a series of nuclear tests at the Pokhran range in Rajasthan's Thar Desert, after an earlier test in the same location. The first tests in that May round were given codenames, and the series was completed in a second round a few days later. India's approach to these weapons has been shaped by its stated policy on their use, which commits it to not striking first. A major turning point came when a group of nuclear suppliers granted India a waiver that allowed nuclear trade, even though India is not a signatory to the Non-Proliferation Treaty. Today India is pursuing a three-stage plan that uses thorium for sustainable power, and a prototype fast breeder reactor is part of that effort. These milestones show how the domestic programme, testing record and diplomacy have developed side by side.

Q1.

In which year did India conduct its first nuclear test, 'Smiling Buddha', at Pokhran? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Who is regarded as the father of India's nuclear programme? (name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did the Apsara reactor become operational? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which station became India's first commercial nuclear power plant when it began operations in 1969? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many nuclear tests did India conduct in total in the Pokhran-II series of May 1998? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the name of India's policy that pledges no first nuclear strike? (short phrase)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year did the NSG grant India a waiver enabling nuclear trade? (year)

Answer: _____

July Charter: Typed Answer Practice

Bangladesh's interim government, led by Muhammad Yunus, took part in a major constitutional reform agreement known as the July National Charter. The agreement aims to build what is described as the country's Second Republic and to prevent future authoritarianism. It was signed by a group of political parties together with the interim government, and the reforms were then put to voters in a referendum.

The charter places new limits on the Prime Minister. A lifetime term limit will apply to any individual serving as PM, and the Prime Minister will no longer be able to serve as head of the party and head of government at the same time. The PM also cannot declare a state of emergency alone, because the decision needs written consent from the cabinet and the leader of the opposition.

The charter also changes Parliament. The existing Jatiya Sangsad will become the Lower House, and a new Upper House, called the Senate, will be created. Reserved seats for women in the Lower House will be increased. The Deputy Speaker must be elected from the main opposition party, and a controversial rule that removes MPs who vote against their party will be removed or weakened.

Other changes cover elections and institutions. A non-partisan caretaker government will oversee general elections, and paper ballots will be mandatory. A Supreme Judicial Council and an independent Judicial Appointments Commission are to be formed. Several commissions will receive full financial and administrative independence.

Q1.

How many seats did the BNP win in the 2026 Bangladesh election? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many political parties signed the July National Charter agreement? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many pages long is the July National Charter agreement? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the lifetime term limit for a Prime Minister under the July Charter? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many seats will the new Upper House (Senate) have? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What percentage of votes did the 'Yes' side secure in the referendum? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q7.

How many working days are allotted to reform under the charter? (in number)

Answer: _____

President's Rule Recall

President's Rule is the term used when the Centre takes over the government of a state. The Constitution gives the Centre a duty to make sure that every state government is carried on in accordance with its provisions. When a state's constitutional machinery fails, the Centre can take over under a separate Article, which lets the President issue a proclamation if satisfied that a state government cannot function as the Constitution requires. Such a proclamation is also used when a state does not comply with directions from the Centre. Once a proclamation is issued, Parliament must approve it within a fixed time. If both Houses approve, the arrangement continues for a fixed period. It can be extended, but only with Parliament's approval and only up to an overall limit. During this time, the President can take over the functions of the state government and the powers of the Governor or other executive authorities. The President can also declare that the powers of the state legislature will be exercised by Parliament. A proclamation can be revoked by the President at any time through a later proclamation, and such a revocation does not need Parliamentary approval. Resolutions approving the proclamation in either House need only a simple majority of members present and voting. These rules on duration, approval and revocation are the main points to remember for this topic.

Q1.

What is the maximum overall period, in years, for which President's Rule can be extended? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Within how many months of its issue must both Houses of Parliament approve a proclamation of President's Rule? (in months)

Answer: _____

Q3.

For how many months does President's Rule continue after both Houses approve it? (in months)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which state has experienced President's Rule the most number of times?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Name the 1994 Supreme Court case which held that the President's power to dismiss a State Government is not absolute.

Answer: _____

Q6.

Under which Article does the Centre's duty to ensure that every state government is carried on per the Constitution arise? (article number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which state has experienced the longest single period under President's Rule? (state name)

Answer: _____

Tax and Fiscal Check

Union Budget 2026-27 pairs tax simplification with a cautious fiscal stance. The government decided to replace the old income tax law with a shorter statute, with the aim of reducing disputes between taxpayers and the tax department. Importantly, the existing income tax slabs were kept unchanged, so individuals did not face a change in rates for the year. Remittances for education, medical care and overseas tours were brought under a single simpler rule. A change was also proposed for companies that report high book profits but pay little or no taxable income. Under the proposal, a minimum tax would become a final tax at a lower rate than before, and non-residents would be exempted from it. On the economic side, the budget projects a growth path that combines price growth with real output growth. The government has also set a deficit target for the year and expects public debt, measured against the size of the economy, to fall gradually. A new fiscal plan aims to stabilise that debt ratio by the end of the decade. Capital spending receives special attention because infrastructure investment is seen as a strong multiplier of economic activity. Taken together, these measures seek to combine a stable tax regime with disciplined public finances.

Q1.

What is the fiscal deficit target for FY 2026-27 (in per cent of GDP)?

Answer: _____

Q2.

On which date (day, month and year) does the new Income Tax Act 2025 replace the 1961 Act?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the uniform TCS rate (in per cent) on LRS remittances for overseas tours, education and medical purposes?

Answer: _____

Q4.

To what rate (in per cent) is the Minimum Alternate Tax proposed to be cut?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Under which section of the Income Tax Act 1961 is TCS governed?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the maximum LRS remittance limit per financial year for a resident individual (in USD)?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What nominal GDP growth rate (in per cent) does the budget project for FY 2026-27?

Answer: _____

Fiscal limits and local bodies

The Commission's recommendations also reach beyond the Union and State governments to local bodies, which deliver services at the grassroots level. It recommends grants for both rural and urban local bodies and for disaster management, and it links part of these grants to performance so that local bodies are held accountable. To encourage the growth of cities, it proposes a premium

that rewards the merger of neighbouring peri-urban villages into adjoining urban local bodies, provided the receiving body has a population above a set level. The report also suggests removing a constitutional requirement that Central Finance Commission recommendations be made on the basis of State Finance Commission recommendations. On fiscal matters, the Commission wants the Centre and the States to keep their deficits within set limits by a target year, and it has recommended ending off-budget borrowings by States so that debt is transparent. Some borrowing for capital investment through a long-term, interest-free loan scheme is kept outside the deficit limit. The Commission also urged States to pursue reforms in power distribution companies and to use targeted subsidies that come with sunset clauses.

Q1.

In which year was the 16th Finance Commission set up? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

By which year does the Commission recommend the Centre's fiscal deficit be reduced to 3.5% of GDP? (year, in the form 2030-31)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the recommended fiscal deficit limit for States, as a percentage of GSDP? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which scheme's borrowings are excluded from the fiscal deficit limit? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What cost-sharing ratio applies to disaster management in North-Eastern and Himalayan States? (in the form A:B)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Peri-urban villages are to merge into adjoining urban local bodies whose population is above how many lakh? (in lakh)

Answer: _____

CPI 2024: the numbers behind the changes

When the index is revised to a new base year, the basket is reviewed so that it matches what households now buy. Several parts of the method change in such a revision. The number of items in the basket can rise, and the split between goods and services can shift to give services a larger place. Prices from online sellers may be recorded directly where the market is large enough to be tracked. The grouping of items into divisions, groups and classes follows an international classification standard, and the newer version is adopted in the revision. Housing is handled separately, through a rent index that depends on what households pay for accommodation. Coverage of this rent index can be widened beyond its earlier scope. The weight given to food is also revised, because household spending has diversified. Finally, the agency decides how widely the results are published. Each of these choices affects how accurately the index measures the cost of living.

Q1.

How many items are included in the CPI 2024 basket (in number)?

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many of the CPI 2024 items are services (in number)?

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many online markets will be covered under CPI 2024 (in number)?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which version of the COICOP classification does CPI 2024 follow? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What was the food and beverages weightage under CPI 2012 (in per cent)?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the food and beverages weightage under CPI 2024 (in per cent)?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Apart from urban areas, for which other type of area is the CPI 2024 house rent index compiled? (one word)

Answer: _____

Flagship Programmes and Funding

India's flagship AI efforts combine large-scale infrastructure with social and developmental goals. Public programmes aim to widen access to computing power for researchers, startups and public institutions, so that more people can build and use AI within the country. National strategy emphasises sovereign capacity, meaning that India should rely less on foreign systems for its critical digital needs. Large financial commitments support this push, including pledges for frontier deep-tech research and a broad infrastructure build-out that includes new data centres. A national portal acts as a knowledge hub and helps build the wider AI ecosystem. Several schemes target specific communities, such as women entrepreneurs and young innovators, and some are delivered through partnerships with government bodies and research institutions. Internationally, India's initiatives sit alongside global bodies that guide responsible AI development and the governance processes that set guardrails for advanced AI systems. Together, these programmes aim to turn national ambition into practical tools that serve citizens across sectors and languages, while keeping ethics and inclusion at the centre of the effort.

Q1.

What budget, in crore, backs the IndiaAI Mission? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many sovereign GPUs does IndiaAI Mission 2.0 aim to onboard? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which city is AIRAWAT, India's largest AI supercomputing system, located? (city)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which company manufactured AIRAWAT? (company name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which programme identifies scalable AI solutions for development challenges and is implemented with Startup India? (programme name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which city is the secretariat of GPAI based? (city)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which institute spearheads the Bharat GenAI initiative? (institute, short name)

Answer: _____

Indian Laws and Agencies Recall

India relies on a mix of laws and specialised bodies to fight corruption in public life. The Prevention of Corruption Act penalises corruption by public servants and those who abet it, while the Prevention of Money Laundering Act prohibits the use of proceeds of crime. Citizens gain smoother and greater access to information through a citizen-centric approach to governance. The Central Vigilance Commission oversees vigilance administration and advises the executive on corruption matters. The Central Bureau of Investigation is described as the premier investigating police agency for combating corruption in public life, and it serves as the nodal agency for INTERPOL in India. The Directorate of Enforcement deals with cases related to money laundering by public servants. The Comptroller and Auditor General acts as the Supreme Audit Institution that helps identify financial mismanagement, corruption or fraud. Together these institutions form the backbone of India's governance and accountability framework, although the booklet notes that persistent challenges remain. Each body works within its own mandate, and together they support the country's broader efforts against corruption. The Right to Information Act is one of the tools that gives citizens a more open route to government information. Public servants, who are the focus of several of these laws, face penalties when they engage in corruption.

Q1.

In which year was the Central Vigilance Commission established? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which Article is cited for the Comptroller and Auditor General of India? (article number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Act, enacted in 2014, allows registration of corruption or misuse of power against public servants? (name of the Act)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the Directorate of Enforcement established as an Enforcement Unit? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which committee's recommendations led to the setting up of the Central Vigilance Commission?
(name of committee)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the fixed tenure of the CAG of India, ignoring the age limit? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was the Central Bureau of Investigation formed? (year)

Answer: _____

Concerns and Tribal Facts

The Great Nicobar project has raised serious environmental and social concerns. Critics argue that the environmental study relied on too little field data, so it may not capture how the island's species behave across changing conditions. Compensatory afforestation has been proposed in a different state, but critics say a new plantation cannot reproduce the unique structure and species of a natural forest. Indigenous communities are at the centre of the debate. Certain tribal groups are considered especially vulnerable. Any disturbance could cause loss of habitat, disruption of traditions and a hit to local livelihoods. The island is also exposed to natural hazards. Earthquakes, tsunamis and the impacts of climate change add to concerns about building large facilities there. Supporters point to strategic and economic gains, but the debate shows how difficult it is to weigh development against ecological and tribal rights. Whether the project proceeds responsibly will depend on how well the safeguards are enforced in practice.

Q1.

What area of tropical rainforest is reported to be diverted, in sq. km (give the number)?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Roughly how many million trees is the project reported to cut (give the number)?

Answer: _____

Q3.

The proposed compensatory afforestation is located in which state?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group is directly threatened by the project?

Answer: _____

Q5.

The Environmental Impact Assessment was based on data from how many seasons (in number)?

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many PVTGs has the Ministry of Tribal Affairs identified (in number)?

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year did the Government rename Primitive Tribal Groups as PVTGs?

Answer: _____

Schemes, Atlas and Accreditation

India's wetland policy combines conservation with tourism and local livelihoods. Under one capacity building scheme, a tourism ministry works with the environment ministry to make better use of wetlands. The scheme aims to enhance biodiversity, carbon stock, eco-tourism opportunities and income for local communities. Its primary focus is a shift from crowded visits to higher-value nature tourism at ecologically sensitive wetlands. Conservation at the national level is carried out through state-level bodies. A national atlas of decadal wetland change documents how these wetlands have changed over time, and an original version of that atlas was released by a national space agency unit. Such records help authorities see which wetlands have altered over a decade. Tourism is also being planned along cultural routes. A new corridor will connect Ayodhya with another place in the same state, combining cultural visits with nature, and the corridor is announced as a new route in the state. Cities are recognised too. Wetland City Accreditation is granted only to cities that satisfy all six international criteria, including measures for conservation of wetlands and their ecosystem services. The programme aims to promote conservation and wise use of urban and peri-urban wetlands.

Q1.

In which year was the original National Wetland Decadal Change Atlas released by SAC?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which organisation prepared the National Wetland Decadal Change Atlas? (give the short form)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the National Wetland Conservation Program started?

Answer: _____

Q4.

For how many years is a Wetland City accreditation valid? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which city was COP15 of the Ramsar Convention held in 2025?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year did COP 12 of the Ramsar Convention approve the Wetland City Accreditation Program?

Answer: _____

Q7.

The Nature-Culture Tourism Corridor is to be developed between Ayodhya and which other place in Uttar Pradesh?

Answer: _____

Research, Space and Maritime Security

India is investing in science, space and maritime cooperation at several levels. A new fund under the Anusandhan National Research Foundation is designed to carry research from the laboratory to industrial-scale manufacturing. Its focus areas include biotechnology, artificial intelligence, deep tech and advanced manufacturing, and it is meant to reduce import dependence. In space, the Union Budget has approved two major telescope projects in Ladakh, a region chosen for its high altitude, clear skies and minimal light pollution. One project will study the Sun, including solar magnetism and space weather, while the other will look at exoplanets, the early universe and

galaxy evolution. Maritime security is also addressed through the Combined Maritime Forces, a voluntary multinational partnership headquartered in Manama, Bahrain that aims to protect sea lanes and prevent piracy and smuggling. India has taken on a larger role in this partnership by commanding one of its task forces for the first time, with a focus on training and capacity building. Together, these developments show how India links research, infrastructure and security. Such schemes are meant to strengthen domestic capability, support new industries and reduce dependence on imports in strategic sectors.

Q1.

Under the research fund described, what is the duration of the scheme (in years)?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the minimum Technology Readiness Level (TRL) that the fund supports?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the aperture of the National Large Solar Telescope (in metres)?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the size of the National Large Optical Telescope, a segmented mirror telescope (in metres)?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which place in Ladakh is the National Large Solar Telescope located?

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many nations are members of the Combined Maritime Forces (in number)?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Combined Task Force did India command for the first time (give the number)?

Answer: _____

Global security and forums: TITA practice

Security and maritime cooperation were in focus in early 2026. NATO launched a mission to raise its security presence in the Arctic region, with the aim of safeguarding member states, protecting territorial integrity and keeping the region stable. The mission responds to rising military activity in the area and to the growing strategic and economic interest of outside powers in the Arctic. Competition over shipping routes and natural resources is also emerging in the region.

In the Indian Ocean, India took over the chairmanship of a multilateral forum of navies from the region. The forum is voluntary and inclusive, and its purpose is to enhance maritime cooperation among the littoral states of the ocean. Leading such a forum adds to a country's maritime profile in the region.

Disarmament formed another strand of the year's news. The Indian Army hosted a United Nations training programme on small arms control for the Asia-Pacific region, held together with a UN office that works inside the UN Secretariat. That office traces its roots to an earlier department and works to strengthen international peace and security through disarmament. Taken together, these stories show how military, naval and diplomatic tools are used to manage risk. Each case

reflects a balance between cooperation and competition among states.

Q1.

Which NATO command leads the Arctic Sentry Mission? (give the full name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Indian Ocean Naval Symposium established?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the UN Office for Disarmament Affairs established?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which city is the headquarters of the UN Office for Disarmament Affairs located?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which Indian city did the Indian Army host the UN small arms control training programme? (city name only)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which navy initiated the Indian Ocean Naval Symposium?

Answer: _____

Q7.

The UN Office for Disarmament Affairs has a core objective of complete elimination of which category of weapons? (abbreviation or full name)

Answer: _____